Method of Handling Traffic: Crew Instructions

Project Information

- **Speed limit:** 55 mph
- **Road type:** Rural
- **Closure type:** Shoulder Closure · Divided Highway
- **Work zone length:** 50 ft
- **Jurisdiction:** Not set
- **Generated:** 2026-10-24

Required Equipment

- 12× Construction/Warning Sign (see sign list below)
  - 2× G20-1 ROAD CONSTRUCTION (NEXT 50 FT)
  - 2× G20-2 END ROAD WORK
  - 2× G20-5P WORK ZONE plaque
  - 2× W20-1 ROAD WORK AHEAD
  - 2× W20-2 ROAD WORK 1000 FT
  - 2× W21-5aR RIGHT SHOULDER CLOSED AHEAD
- 5× Channelizing Drum (36-inch)
- 8× Traffic Cone (36-inch)
- 1× Arrow Board

Sign Placement Schedule

Sign Code	Description	Distance from Taper
W20-1	ROAD WORK AHEAD	1,500 ft upstream
W20-2	ROAD WORK 1000 FT	1,000 ft upstream
W21-5aR	RIGHT SHOULDER CLOSED AHEAD	500 ft upstream
G20-5P	WORK ZONE plaque	Within work zone
G20-2	END ROAD WORK	Downstream of work zone

Setup Procedure

Important: Set up from downstream to upstream (against traffic flow). This ensures you are always working behind protection.

1. Position arrow board at the upstream start of the shoulder taper (station 728 ft). Set it to caution mode (flashing caution or alternating diamond). Shoulder work takes caution mode only, never an arrow (MUTCD 11th Ed. §6L.06 ¶18, p. 833; CDOT S-630-1 Sheet 2 General Note 26). Activate flashing.
2. Place the END ROAD WORK sign (G20-2) at the downstream termination (station -150 ft), right side of road 28 ft from centerline. Place matching sign on left side.
3. Place 2 traffic cones in the downstream taper, between station -50 ft (shoulder edge) and station 0 (lane edge) at 25 ft spacing. This taper returns traffic from the lane edge back to the shoulder edge past the work zone (MUTCD §6B.08 downstream taper). Then place 2 traffic cones along the right lane edge at 50 ft spacing, starting at station 0

(downstream end of work zone) and working upstream to station 50 ft. Offset: 24 ft from centerline. Then continue the line through the buffer space: 4 more traffic cones at 99 ft spacing, from station 50 ft up to the taper (station 545 ft), at the same offset. Keep the buffer itself clear of work and equipment (CDOT S-630-1 Sheet 2 General Note 18b: no more than twice the speed limit apart along the buffer space).

4. Place G20-5P WORK ZONE plaque(s) within the work zone at approximately 50 ft intervals. Place matching plaques on left side.
5. Place 5 channelizing drums in the shoulder taper, starting at station 545 ft and working upstream to station 728 ft. Space drums at 46 ft intervals. Drums transition from the lane edge (24 ft) to the shoulder edge (34 ft).
6. Place advance warning signs upstream of the taper: Place matching signs on left side at each location.
   - W21-5aR at 500 ft upstream of taper start (station 1,228 ft), right side.
   - W20-2 at 1,000 ft upstream of taper start (station 1,728 ft), right side.
   - W20-1 at 1,500 ft upstream of taper start (station 2,228 ft), right side.

Takedown Procedure

Important: Remove from upstream to downstream (with traffic flow). Remove advance warning signs first, work zone devices last.

1. Remove advance warning signs: W20-1 first, then W20-2, then W21-5aR. Remove both sides at each station.
2. Remove taper drums from upstream to downstream.
3. Deactivate and remove arrow board.
4. Remove work zone cones from upstream to downstream.
5. Remove G20-5P plaques.
6. Remove G20-2 END ROAD WORK sign(s).

Safety Notes

- All personnel in the work zone must wear ANSI Class 2 (daytime) or Class 3 (nighttime) high-visibility apparel.
- Divided highway: this plan posts signs on both sides of the roadway by choice. CDOT S-630-1 Sheet 2 General Note 8 doesn't require it when only one shoulder is closed (Case 11 on Sheet 7).
- Maintain 495 ft longitudinal buffer space between the taper and the work area at all times.
- Maximum speed reduction per sign installation: 15 mph (CDOT S-630-1 Sheet 2 General Note 3).
- This plan was generated by MHT Tool. A certified Traffic Control Supervisor (TCS) must review, approve, and sign before field implementation.
- Reference: CDOT S-630-1, MUTCD 11th Edition Part 6, Colorado Supplement (effective January 18, 2026).

Pedestrian and Bicycle Accommodation

- No pedestrian or bicycle facility is flagged as affected by this closure. If a sidewalk, crosswalk, shared-use path, or bike facility exists within the work zone in the field, stop and have the TCS update the plan before setup.
- The TCS verifies pedestrian and bicycle accommodation on site; where a facility is maintained, it must remain accessible and detectable per MUTCD standards.

Emergency Access

- All travel lanes remain open; the closure occupies the shoulder only. Emergency vehicles pass through the work zone in the open lanes.

- The Traffic Control Supervisor completes and confirms the emergency access plan for this site and coordinates notification of police, fire, and emergency medical responder agencies prior to work (TCS duties per CDOT Standard Specifications 630.11).
- An emergency access plan is a required minimum element of the approved Method of Handling Traffic (CDOT 630.10(a)); this section is draft input for it, not the approved plan.